RE: Haven’t heard back from the School of Physics, Astronomy and Mathematics - Case Forwarded from AskHerts (Case Number: 00063034)

admsta <admsta@herts.ac.uk> 6 March 2024 at 09:26
To: "tompiccolo50@gmail.com" <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Dear Tom,

Thank you for your queries for us in admissions – I hope we are able to answer your questions for you in this reply.

Level 2 qualifications are indeed equivalent to GCSEs; We would consider a pass in a Level 2 BTEC comparable to a Grade 4/C at GCSE level and anything higher would be deemed acceptable for academic recognition. If we were to be thorough, we would probably class a Distinction as comparable to roughly a 7 or 8, and a Distinction* would equate to a 9. Please note, that when applying to Herts, we will predominantly be looking for you GCSE, or Level 2 equivalent, in English Language and Maths (and in bio-based courses we will be looking for Science too), although we encourage applicants to list all academic achievements in order for us to evaluate your academic abilities, strengths, and interests.

When it comes to Level 3, the content of the lessons that are taught would be considered more challenging than that of Level 2 (essentially, Level 2 gives you the basic knowledge needed to begin learning Level 3 content). In some cases, an applicant could have achieved a 9 in GCSE Maths but achieved a D in A Level Maths as the subject knowledge is more complex and applied differently than at GCSE. You are correct in saying that they are not comparable because the content is harder to apply as you progress – as is the purpose of learning. Because of this, UCAS recognised Level 3 qualifications at a higher level, meaning these will generate the UCAS points needed to apply to university and not Level 2.

In terms of academic difficulty between courses, it would depend on the ability of the student; Some students are found to have a better aptitude to the sciences and some are better with humanities for example, so it would be unfair to say one is more difficult than another. However, we would infer that the courses that advertise higher entry tariffs would contain more subject content (and as such, more concentrated teaching) and require more specific knowledge compared to a course with lower entry tariffs.

I hope this helps answer your questions. If you have any further queries, or would like further clarity, please do not hesitate to ask.

Kind regards

Molly Padbury

Admissions Administrator

Standard Team

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Dear Team,

The following Case has been forwarded to **Standard Admissions** from AskHerts *(Salesforce)*.

Case Opened Date:

05/03/2024

Case From:

| tompiccolo50@gmail.com

Case Subject:

Haven’t heard back from the School of Physics, Astronomy and Mathematics

Case Description:

Hello

I recently sent an enquiry regarding entry requirements to the school mentioned- I have not received any response from them

Would be grateful if you could remind them I have sent an email to them.

Also could you please forward the following onto the team that deals with university admissions at Hertfordshire:

Hello

Consider two hypothetical Level 2 courses:

A Level 2 Diploma in Dog Grooming and Level 2 GCSE’s (9-1) are also Level 2. Does this means that a Distinction (highest grade) in the dog grooming diploma and an average GCSE grade of 9 (highest GCSE grade) are the same, academically?

Even though they are both Level 2 qualifications they don’t compare on a standardised test which measures academic ability. There is a large difference in score points on this test between the highest grades in both of these separate level 2 courses.

But they are both Level 2 qualifications.

Equally, does simply doing a Level 3 qualification- for instance passing A Level Maths with a D grade- instantly mean you are better than those people with 9’s in GCSE Maths?

They also don’t compare.

There is a difference of over 100 points on the standardised test I mentioned: over 1 international standard deviation- difference between people with a D in the Level 3 A Level Maths qualification and people with grade 9’s in GCSE Maths (Level 2)

Essentially- are all university undergraduate programmes equivalent in academic difficulty or are differences in academic difficulty reflected in different entry requirements

For instance, Dentistry asking for AAA whereas Nursing asking for CCC

Many thanks and I hope you can provide advice on my query

Tom

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Thanks

Tom

Sent from Outlook for iOS<https://aka.ms/o0ukef>

Kind Regards

Student Enquiries and Enrolment Team

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Ask Herts. Your Questions Answered. Online. On Campus.

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